JAMES MITCHELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Senior Forward Deployed Engineer with 8 years of hands-on experience supporting mission-critical infrastructure at customer sites. I've spent the last half decade troubleshooting complex distributed systems, mentoring junior engineers in field environments, and building strong relationships with enterprise clients. I work best when I'm in the trenches solving real problems rather than sitting behind a desk, and I take pride in making sure customers feel supported and confident in their deployments.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Forward Deployed Engineer

TechVault Solutions

techvault.io

London, United Kingdom

August 2022 - Present

Led on-site deployments for 12+ Fortune 500 clients across Europe, managing infrastructure architecture decisions and coordinating with remote teams to resolve complex technical issues within SLA windows.

Reduced customer downtime by 40% through proactive monitoring system implementation and established runbook documentation that enabled faster incident response.

Mentored 4 junior field engineers in troubleshooting methodologies, system design principles, and professional client communication during their first deployments.

Managed multi-site installations for EMEA region, traveling 60% of the time to coordinate hardware deployments, network configuration, and knowledge transfer sessions with customer IT teams.

Forward Deployed Systems Engineer

Sentinel Cloud Infrastructure

sentinel.co.net

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

March 2020 - July 2022

Deployed and configured hybrid cloud environments for financial services and healthcare clients, ensuring compliance with regulatory requirements including PCI-DSS and HIPAA standards.

Troubleshot network performance issues at customer sites, identifying root causes in load balancing and storage connectivity that improved application response times by 35%.

Developed disaster recovery procedures and conducted quarterly failover testing with client teams to validate business continuity plans.

Created technical documentation and video walkthroughs for common maintenance tasks, reducing support ticket volume by 25% and improving customer self-service capability.

Field Support Engineer

DataCore Systems Ltd

datacore.com

Glasgow, United Kingdom

June 2016 - February 2020

Provided on-site technical support for enterprise storage and backup solutions, resolving hardware failures and performance degradation issues for clients in financial services and manufacturing sectors.

Completed Cisco CCNA and CompTIA Security+ certifications while employed, demonstrating commitment to continuous professional development and staying current with industry standards.

Worked rotating on-call rotation supporting critical production systems, averaging 15-minute response time to customer escalations during business hours.

Coordinated with engineering teams to reproduce and escalate complex bugs found in production environments, contributing to 3 major software releases.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science (2:1 Hons)

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2016

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Azure, Google Cloud Platform

Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, VMware vSphere, Hyper-V

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VPN, Cisco IOS, pfSense

Storage: SAN administration, NAS configuration, backup and replication

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, ELK Stack, Splunk, Grafana

Operating Systems: Linux (Ubuntu, CentOS, RHEL), Windows Server 2016-2022

Scripting: Bash, Python, PowerShell

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server

Version Control: Git

Security: SSL/TLS certificates, firewall configuration, access controls

Protocols: SSH, RDP, HTTP/HTTPS, SNMP